# DataTables Header Alignment CSS Explained

A simple explanation of the CSS rule that keeps column titles and sort arrows in the same position.

## The code

```
#docTable thead th > .dt-column-header,
#filesTable thead th > .dt-column-header {
    justify-content: flex-start !important;
    flex-direction: row !important;
}
```

## What it does

It keeps the **column titles and sort arrows** in the same position for every column.

## Why it is needed

DataTables 2 puts each header title and its sort arrow inside a small box called `.dt-column-header`. For number and date columns, it flips this box so the title and arrow move to the **right**. That is why some headings were left aligned and others right aligned.

## What each line does

- `#docTable thead th > .dt-column-header` picks that small box inside the header cells of your two tables ( `docTable` and `filesTable` ).
- `justify-content: flex-start` pushes the title to the **left**.
- `flex-direction: row` keeps the order as **title first, then arrow**. DataTables reverses it for right-aligned columns.
- `!important` makes sure these rules win over DataTables' own CSS.

## How it works with the other rule

Your earlier rule `text-align: left` fixes the **cell values** and the header text. This rule fixes the header's **inner box** (title plus arrow). You need both for a fully consistent look.

```
#docTable th,
#docTable td,
#filesTable th,
#filesTable td {
    text-align: left !important;
}
```